

General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

Civil Uprisings



Civil Uprisings



The word ‘civil’ encompasses everything that is not related to defence/military, but here we have included those uprisings that were generally led by deposed native rulers or their descendants, former zamindars, landlords, ex-retainers, and officials of the conquered kingdoms, or sometimes by religious leaders.

Major Causes of Civil Uprisings:

- Rapid changes in the **economy, administration, and land revenue system**, introduced by **Britishers** went against the people.
- **Several zamindars and poligars** who had lost control over their land and its revenues due to the colonial rule had personal scores to settle with the new rulers.
- Due to colonial policies, the **ruin of Indian handicraft industries** impoverished millions of artisans whose misery was further compounded by the disappearance of their traditional patrons and buyers—princes, chieftains, and zamindars.
- The **priestly classes instigated hatred and rebellion against the alien rule**, because the religious preachers, priests, pundits, maulvis, etc., had been dependent on the traditional landed and bureaucratic elite

- The **foreign character of the British rulers**, who always remained alien to this land, and their contemptuous treatment of the native people hurt the pride of the latter.
- **Social policies** of the British were taken as an **interference in personal matters**.
- **Subsidiary Alliance, Doctrine of Lapse, and direct annexation** of the territory were not liked by the Kings and the people.

General Characteristics of Civil Uprisings:

- The **semi-feudal leaders of civil uprisings** were **backward-looking** and traditional in outlook.
- Their basic objective was to **restore earlier forms of rule and social relations**.
- These uprisings were the **result of local causes and grievances** and were also **localized in their consequences**.

Point To Remember:

- **Feudalism: It's a social system** in which people worked and fought for nobles who gave them protection and the use of land in return.
- **In short, landowners became a politically and economically dominant section of the society.**

Important Civil Uprisings:

NAME	WHERE	LEADER/ TRIBE	CAUSES	OUTCOME
Santhal Uprising (the 1850s-1860s)	Rajmahal Hills	Sido, Kanhu, Santhals	Oppression by revenue officials, police, money lenders, landlords, etc.	Santhal Pargana as a separate district was created.
Ahom Revolt (1828)	Assam	Gomdhar Konwar	After Burma War 1 (1824 - 1826), instead of withdrawal,	The government followed the conciliatory policy.

			Britishers incorporated Ahom's territory.	Upper Assam was given to Maharaja Purandar Singh Narendra and part of the kingdom was restored to the Assamese king.
Sanyasi Revolt (1763-1800) Or Fakir Rebellion	Eastern India	Majnum Shah (or Majnu Shah), Chirag Ali, Musa Shah, Bhawani Pathak and Debi Chaudhurani were important leaders.	The disastrous famine of 1770 and the harsh economic order of the British compelled a group of sanyasis in Eastern India to fight the British yoke.	It was only after a prolonged action that Warren Hastings could subdue the sanyasis. Anandamath, a semi-historical novel by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay is based on the Sanyasi Revolt.
Revolt in Midnapore and Dhalbhum (1766-74)	Midnapore and Dhalbhum	Damodar Singh and Jagannath Dhal.	Introduction of the new land revenue system by the English in 1772.	The zamindars of Dhalbhum, Manbhum, Raipur, Panchet, Jhatibuni, Karnagarh, and Bagri, living in

				the vast tract of Jungle Mahals of west and north-west Midnapore—were ultimately dispossessed of their zamindaries by 1800s.
Revolt of Raja of Vizianagaram (1794)	Vizianagaram	Vijayaramaraju, the Raja of Vizianagaram	The East India Company went on to demand a tribute of three lakh rupees from Vizayaramaraju, the Raja of Vizianagaram and asked him to disband his troops	The Raja died in a battle at Padmanabham (in modern Visakhapatnam district in Andhra Pradesh) in 1794 . Vizianagaram came under the Company's rule.
Resistance of Kerala Varma Pazhassi Raja (1797; 1800-05)	Kottayam	Pazhassi Raja also called Kerala Simham	The new Raja, to meet the revenue target fixed by the Company, levied exorbitant rates	Pazhassi Raja organized a large force of Nairs which was supplemented

			of tax on the peasants. This led to a mass resistance by the peasants under the leadership of Pazhassi Raja in 1793.	by Mappilas and Pathans And died in the gun battle against Company forces.
Uprisings in Ganjam and Gumsur (1800, 1835-37)	Ganjam and Gumsur	Strikara Bhanj, JIani Deo of Vizianagar (Poddakimedi) and Jagannath Deo of Pratapgiri (Chinakimedi).	Strikara Bhanj, a zamindar of Gumsur in Ganjam district, refused to pay revenues in 1797. In 1800, he openly rebelled and defied the public authorities.	The struggle lasted till February 1837, when Doora Bisayi, a formidable leader, was arrested. The zamindari of Gumsur was forfeited.
Uprisings in Palamau (1800-02)	Palamau	Bhukhan Singh, a Chero chief,	Crises of agrarian landlordism and feudal system.	Colonel Jones camped for two years in Palamau and Sarguja to suppress the rebellion. Bhukhan Singh died in 1802 and

				Subsequently, the insurrection calmed down.
Poligars' Revolt (1795-1805)	Tirunelveli, Ramanathapuram, Sivaganga, Sivagiri, Madurai, and North Arcot (South India)	Kattabomman Nayakan, the poligar of Panjalankurichi, led the insurrection between 1795 and 1799	The problem started in 1781 when the Nawab of Arcot gave the management and control of Tinneveli and the Carnatic Provinces to the East India Company.	The nawab surrendered the civil and military administration of all the territories and dependencies of the Carnatic exclusively to the Company in perpetuity.
Diwan Velu Thampi's Revolt (1808-1809)	The state of Travancore,	Prime Minister (or Dalawa) Velu Thampi	subsidiary alliance arrangement under Wellesley in 1805, caused deep resentment in the region. The ruler was not able to pay the subsidy and fell in arrears. The British resident of Travancore was meddling in	The Maharaja of Travancore had not wholly supported the rebellion and defected to the side of the Company. Velu Thampi killed himself to avoid capture. The rebellion petered out.

			the internal affairs of the state.	
Kutch or Cutch Rebellion (1816-1832)	Kutch	The British interfered in the internal feuds of the Kutch and, in 1819, Raja Bharmal II raised Arab and African troops with the firm intention of removing the British from his territory.	The administrative innovations made by the Regency Council coupled with excessive land assessment caused deep resentment. The news of the British reverses in the Burma War emboldened the chiefs to rise in revolt and demand the restoration of Bharamal II.	After extensive military operations failed to control the situation, The company's authorities were compelled to follow a conciliatory policy.
Paika Rebellion (1817)	Odisha	The Paiks of Odisha were the traditional landed militia ('foot soldiers'	The English Company's conquest of Odisha in 1803, and the The	The Paika Rebellion succeeded in getting large remissions of arrears,

		literally) and enjoyed rent-free land tenures for their military service and policing functions on a hereditary basis. Bakshi Jagabandhu Bidyadhar had been the military Chief of the forces of the Raja of Khurda	dethronement of the Raja of Khurda had greatly reduced the power and prestige of the Paikas . Further, the extortionist land revenue policy of the Company caused resentment among zamindars and peasants alike.	reductions in assessments, suspension of the sale of the estates of defaulters at discretion, a new settlement on fixed tenures and other adjuncts of liberal governance.
Waghera Rising (1818-1820)	Baroda (Gujrat)	Waghera chiefs of Okha Mandal	Resentment against the alien rule coupled with the exactions of the Gaekwad of Baroda supported by the British government	The Wagheras carried out inroads into British territory during 1818-19. A peace treaty was signed in November 1820.
Kolhapur and Savantvadi Revolts	Kolhapur state (Maharashtra)	The Gadkari's were a hereditary	These garrisons were disbanded during an	The British authorities introduced many

1844.		military class that was garrisoned in the Maratha forts.	administrative reorganization in Kolhapur state after 1844. Facing the spectre of unemployment, the Gadkari's rose in revolt and occupied the Samangarh and Bhudargarh forts	laws to bring the region under control.
Kuka Movement 1840	Western Punjab	Bhagat Jawahar Mal (also called Sian Saheb) and Baba Ram Singh. (He founded the Namdhari Sikh sect.)	On the political side, the Kukas wanted to remove the British and restore the Sikh rule over Punjab	As the movement gained in popularity, the British took several steps to crush it in the period between 1863 and 1872. In 1872, Ram Singh was deported to Rangoon.